

A world of reactions

Student: Class:

Balancing a chemical equation	Example: Methane gas will burn in air. This is a combustion reaction. This type of reaction produces CO ₂ and H ₂ O.												
Step 1: Start with the word equation and name all of the reactants and products.	_____ gas + _____ gas $\longrightarrow$ carbon dioxide + water												
Step 2: Replace the words in the word equation with formulae and rewrite the equation.	_____ gas = CH ₄ Oxygen gas = ____ (reactants) _____ = CO ₂ Water vapour = ____ (products) _____ $\longrightarrow$ _____												
Step 3: Count the number of atoms of each element (represented by the formulae of the reactants and products).	<table><tr><th>Element</th><th>Reactants</th><th>Products</th></tr><tr><td>C</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>H</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>O</td><td></td><td></td></tr></table>	Element	Reactants	Products	C			H			O		
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H													
O													
Step 4: If the number of atoms of each element is the same on both sides of the equation, the equation is already balanced. If not, numbers need to be placed in front of one or more of the formulae to balance the equation. These numbers are called coefficients and they multiply all of the atoms in the formula.	To balance the hydrogen atoms, put a 2 in front of H₂O: CH₄ + O₂ $\longrightarrow$ CO₂ + 2H₂O. The oxygen atoms can be balanced by putting a 2 in front of the O₂ on the reactant side: CH₄ + 2O₂ $\longrightarrow$ CO₂ + 2H₂O. The equation is now balanced. It can be checked by counting the number of atoms of each element on both sides of the new equation. <table><tr><th>Element</th><th>Reactants</th><th>Products</th></tr><tr><td>C</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>H</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>O</td><td></td><td></td></tr></table>	Element	Reactants	Products	C			H			O		
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Step 5: Add physical state symbols.													

Balancing a chemical equation	Example: Ethene gas will burn in air. This is a combustion reaction. This type of reaction produces CO ₂ and H ₂ O.														
Step 1: Start with the word equation and name all of the reactants and products.	_____ gas + _____ gas $\longrightarrow$ carbon dioxide + water														
Step 2: Replace the words in the word equation with formulae and rewrite the equation.	Ethene gas = C ₂ H ₄ Oxygen gas = _____ (reactants) _____ = CO ₂ Water vapour = _____ (products) _____ $\longrightarrow$ _____														
Step 3: Count the number of atoms of each element (represented by the formulae of the reactants and products).	<table><tr><th>Element</th><th>Reactants</th><th>Products</th></tr><tr><td>C</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>H</td><td></td><td></td></tr><tr><td>O</td><td></td><td></td></tr></table>	Element	Reactants	Products	C			H			O				
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Step 4: If the number of atoms of each element is the same on both sides of the equation, the equation is already balanced. If not, numbers need to be placed in front of one or more of the formulae to balance the equation. These numbers are called coefficients and they multiply all of the atoms in the formula.	_____ _____ _____ _____ Check the equation is balanced by counting the number of atoms of each element on both sides of the new equation.														
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